

The Washington Post

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RE V1 V2 V3 V4



Sunny 68/50 • Tomorrow: Partly sunny 71/56 **B20**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

FRIDAY, OCTOBER 17, 2025 • \$4

Court stops deployment of Guard in Ill. for now

Two judges scold Trump administration over actions by federal agents

BY MARK BERMAN, MARIANNE LEVINE AND KIM BELLWARE

Judges on Thursday rebuked the Trump administration for its arguments involving military troops and actions by federal officers in the Chicago area, reflecting a degree of skepticism in high-profile legal battles swirling around the country's third-biggest city.

President Donald Trump has sought to deploy the National Guard in and around Chicago, where his administration's immigration enforcement actions have prompted protests.

A federal appeals court panel said Thursday that it would not let Trump send troops anywhere in Illinois for now, leaving in place a lower-court ruling blocking his administration from dispatching the National Guard there.

"The spirited, sustained, and occasionally violent actions of demonstrators in protest of the federal government's immigration policies and actions, without more, does not give rise to a danger of rebellion against the government's authority," the panel wrote.

Federal officials remain in and around the Chicago area as part of an immigration action called "Operation Midway Blitz." Protests and some clashes between demonstrators and authorities have continued to unfold in the area, particularly around an Immigration and Customs Enforcement facility in Broadview, a nearby suburb, that has become the center of the confrontations.

During a hearing Thursday morning, a judge said she had "serious concerns" that federal authorities were not following

SEE CHICAGO ON A20

A test for fragile truce in Gaza



HEIDI LEVINE/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Family members mourn Tamir Nimrodi, an 18-year-old soldier whose remains were recently returned by Hamas, at his funeral Thursday in Kfar Saba, Israel. Hamas says finding the bodies of the remaining hostages requires special equipment it does not have. Israel says failing to return them would violate the ceasefire. **Story, A11**

Europe grapples with line between hate, free speech

BY KARLA ADAM AND KATE BRADY

LONDON — President Donald Trump claimed that Europeans are losing their "wonderful right of freedom of speech." Elon Musk told a far-right rally in London that Britons are "scared to exercise their free speech." And Vice President JD Vance warned that U.S. troops stationed in Germany could be jailed for a "mean tweet."

Amid such attacks by Trump and his allies, many in Europe scoffed. This is a continent where pluralistic, parliamentary democ-

racy is the norm, rule of law is sacred, human rights are respected deeply, and cherished personal liberties are balanced against society's broader welfare, including protection of minorities against hate.

The eye-rolling was all the more pronounced given Trump's apparent hypocrisy — with his glee over Jimmy Kimmel's temporary suspension, his swiftly dismissed \$15 billion defamation suit against the New York Times, and the efforts by his administration to control reporters who

SEE FREE SPEECH ON A14

Helicopters, B-52s expand U.S. activity near Venezuela

BY ALEX HORTON AND SAMUEL OAKFORD

The U.S. military's elite Special Operations aviation unit appears to have flown in Caribbean waters less than 90 miles from the coast of Venezuela in recent days, according to a visual analysis by The Washington Post.

The helicopters were engaged in training exercises, according to a U.S. official, that could serve as preparation for expanded conflict against alleged drug traffickers, including potentially missions inside Venezuela.

The U.S. military has struck at least five boats allegedly carrying illegal narcotics in international waters, killing at least 27 people, according to U.S. officials, the last one occurring on Tuesday. President Donald Trump said Wednesday he had authorized the Central Intelligence Agency to conduct missions inside the country.

The U.S. has declared it is in "armed conflict" with drug traffickers, though lawmakers and legal experts have said the strikes are unlawful killings of people who are suspected criminals and

SEE VENEZUELA ON A7

Big find in the Big Easy: A Roman soldier's gravestone

BY BEN BRASCH

Daniella Santoro and her husband were clearing underbrush from the backyard of their New Orleans home in March when they stumbled on a mystery that spanned continents and centuries.

What they first thought was a massive rock turned out to be the gravestone of a Roman soldier: Sextus Congenius Verus, a Thracian who sailed aboard the warship Asclepius before dying at age 42 — 1,900 years ago.

The couple eventually learned that the stone had been missing from an Italian museum since the building was bombed in World War II.

But Santoro knew none of that history when she stumbled on the weathered stone. At first she feared it might be an indication that her home was built atop an unmarked African American cemetery — not uncommon for the historically Black neighborhood of Carrollton. So she began asking neighbors and colleagues whether they had come across anything similar.

One of those neighbors pointed Santoro to D. Ryan Gray, a

SEE GRAVESTONE ON A7



VADIM MAKHOV/OP

Not too cold, not too hard. Just right.

A drone captured polar bears making themselves at home last month at an abandoned Soviet-era Arctic research station on Kolyuchin Island, off Chukotka, Russia, in the country's far east, a known safe haven for the vulnerable species whose survival is threatened by warming. **Story, A2**

'It broke me'

Inside the FBI hunt for the online predators who persuaded a 13-year-old to die

BY WILLIAM WAN IN GIG HARBOR, WASH.

The early-morning fog had yet to rise when police found the 13-year-old boy in a parking lot behind a grocery store. His body was illuminated only by the ambient glow of lights on the loading dock.

Around the boy's neck was a white extension cord he had used to hang himself from a black chain-link fence.

A few feet away, investigators spotted something else: an iPhone propped up on the ground, its camera pointed at the teen's body.

At first, local police treated Jay Taylor's death on Jan. 17, 2022, as a suicide. Within days, however, a recording surfaced that revealed something more sinister. Jay's hanging had been live-streamed on Instagram while online users watched.

In messages to Jay, those users suggested the time he should do it — in the middle of the night while his parents slept.

They made sure he had the means — asking him, "You got a rope?"

They tried to persuade him to kill himself naked — urging him, "Take your clothes off, it's hotter."

But by the spring of 2022 — a



COURTESY OF THE TAYLOR FAMILY

Jay Taylor in 2020. His suicide launched a global investigation to find an elusive online user called "White Tiger."

Few months after Jay's death — police in this tiny maritime town on the Puget Sound were stumped. They couldn't figure out who wrote the messages or why they would do something so unthinkable, according to investigators, Jay's family, social media messages and law enforcement records. The detective in charge asked the FBI for help.

The case would thrust investigators into the darkest corners of

SEE INVESTIGATION ON A8

IN THE NEWS

White House's IVF agenda President Donald Trump announced plans to make it easier and more affordable to access in vitro fertilization and fertility drugs. **A17**

Admiral to step down The head of U.S. Southern Command will depart at year's end amid an antidrug crackdown in the region. **A7**

THE NATION **One of Alaska's** biggest airlifts was underway after a powerful storm system hit the state. **A4** **Democratic senators** sank a bill on military spending as the shutdown drags on. **A6**

THE WORLD **India** vowed to stop buying Russian oil, the U.S. president said. That's news to New Delhi. **A12** **Trump said** he and Vladimir Putin will meet within weeks to discuss the war in Ukraine. **A13**

THE ECONOMY **New rules** regarding English proficiency have sidelined about 6,000 truckers since June 1. **A15** **The U.S. Chamber of Commerce**, in its first legal action against the second Trump administration, sued to block the new \$100,000 fee for H-1B visas. **A17**

STYLE **Weighted vests** have moved beyond their tactical origins to become a uniform of middle-class suburbia. **B1**

SPORTS **College football's** "Holy War" — the Utah-BYU game — has grown so intense that leaders are calling for civility. **B7**



OBITUARIES **Susan Stamberg, 87**, the first woman to host a national nightly news show in the U.S. **B13**

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